

Title:	Flexi Benefits Plan	Version:	2.00
Department:	Human Resources	Effective:	5-May-2026

Objective

Flexible Benefit plan (FBP) is that portion of salary which can be received as against different expenses, to primarily augment lifestyle requirements and help maximise your salary. You will have the complete flexibility to design your salary structure within the FBP amount, based on certain anticipated expenses.

Applicability

Full time employees at the level of Deputy Manager and above.

Components available under FBP

1. **Leave Travel Allowance:** Provides tax exemption on travel fares for those travels made while availing leave.
2. **Communication Expenses:** Allowed for one registered hand phone, landline and broadband at employee residence.
3. **Meal Card:** For hassle free use at various restaurants, provides safe digital transaction and tax exemptions
4. **Professional Development:** For pursuing a recognized course aligned with area of work.
5. **Books and Periodicals:** Reimbursements on study materials aligned with area of work.
6. **Self-owned Car Scheme:** For travel made towards in self-owned car.
7. **Car allotment scheme:** As per company scheme.
8. **National Pension Scheme:** For regular contribution towards national pension account while in service and secure a regular income after retirement.
9. **Voluntary Provident Fund:** Helps a mass and sizable savings portfolio and provide long term savings option for those big life milestones or other planned financial contingencies.

Please refer to the details for each of the above components before opting for your FBP

Grade wise Eligibility and limits under FBP

Components	DM	Mgr /Mgr II/ Sr.Mgr/CM	GM/GM II	AVP/DVP	VP/VP II	SVP/SVP II	EVP & Above
LTA	50,000	50,000	75,000	80,000	80,000	100,000	150,000
Communication	18,000	24,000	48,000	48,000	54,000	60,000	66,000
Meal Cards	28,800	28800	28,800	28,800	28,800	28,800	28,800
Professional Development	75,000	100,000	150,000	150,000	200,000	300,000	400,000
National Pension Scheme	10% of Basic	10% of Basic	10% of Basic	10% of Basic	10% of Basic	10% of Basic	10% of Basic
Voluntary Provident Fund	88% of Basic	88% of Basic	88% of Basic	88% of Basic	88% of Basic	88% of Basic	88% of Basic
Books and Periodicals	N/A	N/A	24,000	30,000	36,000	42,000	48,000
Self-Owned Car (includes Fuel, Maintenance & Driver)	N/A	N/A	32,400	32,400	32,400	32,400	32,400
Sub Limit for Fuel			21,600	21,600	21,600	21,600	21,600
Sub Limit for Driver Wage			10,800	10,800	10,800	10,800	10,800
Overall Limit for Company Owned Car Allotment	N/A	N/A	600,000	855,000	1140,000	1,750,000	2,660,000
Sub Limit for Car EMI			300,000	500,000	700,000	12,00,000	2,000,000
Sub Limit for Driver Salary			150,000	175,000	200,000	250,000	300,000
Sub limit for Fuel & Maintenance			150,000	180,000	240,000	300,000	360,000

Note: Flexi components are subject to all income tax and allied regulations and hence may be changed at short notice depending on changes to the same.

Operating Guidelines

- Employee can opt for Flexi Benefits items as defined in this document, subject to appropriate balance under Special Allowance.

2. Flexi Benefits can be claimed through Galaxy (ZingHR) > Claims > CTC Claims
3. Claims are subject to original bills submitted in prescribed format.
4. Submission of bills beyond 90 days from date of bill, will not be considered.
5. No payment can exceed the specific limit set for each item by the employee.
6. Limits of pay items will be prorated based on date of joining.
7. New joiners will get to exercise the FBP post their joining.
8. All unclaimed amounts under FBP will be paid as taxable at the end of FY.
9. National Pension Scheme and Voluntary Provident Fund once opted in, cannot be changed during the current FY.
10. National Pension Scheme, employee cannot get the benefit without PRAN no. To update the PRAN No employee has to update the PRAN number on Zing HR Portal: HR Help desk --> Employee Benefit --> PRAN Creation/Updation
11. Car allotment / self-own car once opted in, cannot be changed during the year.
12. Once car is allotted under the Car Allotment Scheme, employee cannot be changed till closure of existing scheme.
13. Employee can opt either car allotment or self-owned car benefit.
14. Flexi Benefits claim for each financial year should be claimed by end February.
15. All bills will be checked by Finance and in case of any discrepancy identified, action will be taken as per Code of Conduct.
16. For new employees, National Pension Scheme, Professional Development, Car Allotment and Meal Card will not be part of offer letter and same has to be opted for post joining.
17. Any unclaimed amount will be credited post deduction of taxes as appropriate on claim basis.

Flexi Benefit component explained

1. Leave Travel Allowance

1.1. Scope: Travel within the geographical boundary of India, tax benefits can be claimed on the travel expenses incurred for self, spouse, dependent children and parents. Benefits can be claimed twice in a block of 4 years as per the IT guidelines. The various scopes related to LTA claims are summarised below:

- (a) Claims are permissible for domestic travels only.
- (b) Declaration for LTA exemption to be claimed in current block.
- (c) Claims to be made after completion of journey.
- (d) Only Air/Train/Road Travel fare can be claimed.
- (e) Any Overseas travel is not allowed.
- (f) Lodging, food and other expenses, Cab charges for internal touring are not allowed.
- (g) Travel by Air in business class ticket is not allowed.

1.2. Procedure to claim: The following has to be submitted through Compensation claim module in Galaxy (ZingHR)

- Declaration for LTA exemption claimed on in current block.
- Clearly state journey origin and destination.
- For air travel, original boarding Pass and ticket for train travel, original ticket.
- For road travel, bus / cab is allowed where air or train service is not available. Payment will be made for shortest route basis bill submitted and clear demarcation of distance travelled along with the place.
- The current block is 2018-21, 2022-25, and so on.

2. Communication Expenses

2.1. Scope: Applicable for any separate mobile, landline, cash cards and internet broadband connection. Tax benefits can be claimed on the communication expenses incurred on submission of original bills.

The various scopes related to Communication Expenses are summarised below:

- (a) Employees from DM & above grade are eligible.
- (b) Bills allowed for Mobile & Landline call charges, Cash Cards (receipt required) and Internet Connections only.
- (c) Mobile connection bill if already claimed under MER, separate mobile connection bill cannot be claimed. Employee can still claim for Landline/ Broadband expense.
- (d) In case of separate mobile or Internet broadband connection, the connection has to be in employee's name.
- (e) For Landline, it can be in anyone's name (self, spouse, landlord, other family member, etc.), however the address on the bill to match with the residence address (temporary or permanent) as per Company records on Galaxy (ZingHR).
- (f) Phone connection in the name of corporate bodies and firms, address on bill does not match temporary / permanent residence address on records, cash memo, recharges cards (without bill), connection which is used for reimbursement under company policy are not allowed.
- (g) Prepaid bill should not exceed Rs. 750/- per month.

2.2. Procedure to claim: The following has to be submitted along with the Communication Expenses claim submission form:

- Original Invoice needs to be submitted.
- Prepaid and cash card recharges need to be supported with bill.
- Submit claim through compensation claim module on Galaxy (ZingHR).

3. Meal Card

3.1. Scope

- (a) Employees from DM and above grade are eligible.
- (b) To be used for food items only.

- (c) Can be used at restaurants, sweet shops, bakeries, fast food and food items.
- (d) Employee has to furnish the KYC details in case of balance exceeding Rs. 10,000/-.
- (e) Employees need to update their contact number & email on Sodexo website.
- (f) Not to be used for alcoholic beverages.
- (g) One transaction should be done with in every 90 days to avoid any card inactivation charges.
- (h) The balance in the Sodexo Meal Pass Card cannot be cashed out at any point of time.
- (i) In case of Loss / damage of card, employee has to pay replacement cost of Rs. 100/-.
- (j) Once opted, Meal Card will be couriered before end of second week of the following month.
- (k) Monthly Balance will be added to the Card by 7th day of next month.

3.2. Procedure to claim: No need of any separate claim since balance will be uploaded in the card for use of purchase of food items and dining in restaurants.

4. Professional Development

4.1. Scope

- (a) Employee from DM and above grade are eligible.
- (b) Prior approval of the Manager required in the Professional Development form along with the form, attach the Brochure and the original Fee receipt.
- (c) Education courses undertaken outside India includes travel cost, fee & training cost, reasonable lodging & boarding expenses, subject to FERA regulation.
- (d) Benefits are allowed only for AICTE (All India Council for Technical Education) and other accredited courses e.g. part time MBA, etc.
- (e) The Claim for family education & professional development is not covered.
- (f) Claims for membership of institutions, repeat submissions of claims for same or similar courses, claims on letter heads, claims not from registered institutes and claim of last financial year are not allowed.

4.2. Procedure to claim: The following has to be submitted along with the Professional Development Fees claim submission form:

- Original fee receipt and brochure.
- Manager's approval.
- Copy of the application form.
- Submit claim through compensation claim module on Galaxy (ZingHR).

5. Car Allotment Scheme

5.1. Scope

- (a) Employees from AVP and above grade are eligible.

- (b) Expenses towards servicing / accessories, repairs, parking, replacement of tyres/mats, etc.
- (c) Insurance premium for cars (photocopy of original insurance policy).
- (d) Original fuel bills with registration number of the vehicle stated in the same.
- (e) Claim reimbursement for wages to driver hired for Company owned vehicle only.
- (f) Copy of driver's driving license & particulars to be provided for company records and updating the same as and when new driver is hired.
- (g) Employee will not be entitled to claim local conveyance reimbursement for official purpose.
- (h) Once car is allotted under the scheme, employee cannot opt out or change till the closure of existing scheme.
- (i) Employee can opt in for once in the financial year.
- (j) Car EMI will be adjusted every month from monthly salary.
- (k) For car allotment, employee has to ensure that vehicle has been delivered.

5.2. Procedure to claim: The following has to be submitted along with the Car Allotment expenses claim submission form:

- Original invoices to be submitted for fuel, repairs and maintenance, driver and insurance charges.
- Submit claim towards the end of each month from compensation claim module of Galaxy (ZingHR).
- Revenue stamp must necessarily be affixed, and signature taken from the driver on the same to facilitate reimbursement.
- Employee should restrict submission of plain paper bills or incomplete bills, overwriting / editing on bills, unclear description of maintenance services, insurance cover notes, driver acknowledgement or bill from outside work location.

6. Self-owned Car Scheme

6.1. Scope

- (a) Employees from GM and above grade are eligible.
- (b) Car has to be registered in the name of the employee.
- (c) Self-attested copy of RC to be submitted.
- (d) Copy of driver's driving license & particulars has to be provided for company records and updating the same as and when new driver is hired.
- (e) Original fuel bills with registration number of the vehicle stated in the same.
- (f) Claim reimbursement for wages to driver hired for Self-owned vehicle only.
- (g) Employee will not be entitled to claim local conveyance reimbursement for official purpose.
- (h) Employee can opt in anytime in the financial year.

6.2. Procedure to claim: The following has to be submitted along with the Car Allotment expenses claim submission form:

- Original invoices to be submitted for fuel, repairs and maintenance, driver charges.

- Submit claim towards the end of each month from compensation claim module of Galaxy (ZingHR).
- Revenue stamp must necessarily be affixed, and signature taken from the driver on the same to facilitate reimbursement.
- All bills should be from employee work location.
- No claims if employee does not own a car or has not engaged a driver.
- Bills without sign and stamp of the vendor will not be permissible.
- Employee should restrict submission of plain paper bills or incomplete bills, overwriting / editing on bills, unclear description of maintenance services, insurance cover notes, driver acknowledgement or bill from outside work location.

7. Books and Periodicals

7.1. Scope

- (a) Employees from the level of GM and above are eligible.
- (b) Employee has to submit the declaration along with the original bill to payroll in specified format for reimbursement.
- (c) All books and periodicals should be relevant to area of work.
- (d) Submission of fake bills is strictly prohibited.
- (e) Bills of previous financial year will not be entertained.

7.2. Procedure to claim: The following has to be submitted along with the Books and Periodicals expenses claim submission form:

- Original invoices to be submitted for books and periodicals.
- Submit claim through compensation claim module on Galaxy (ZingHR).

8. National Pension Scheme

8.1. Scope

- (a) Maximum 10% of Basic can be opted.
- (b) Minimum annual contribution of Rs. 6000/- is mandatory.
- (c) The scheme is applicable for DM & above.
- (d) Employee has to open PRAN- Permanent Retirement ACCOUNT Number through company.
- (e) **PRAN** is unique and **portable**.
- (f) Withdrawal can be done as per prevailing government guidelines.
- (g) More than one NPS account is not permissible.
- (h) To get the benefit of NPS, PRAN is mandatory.

8. 2. Procedure to claim: The following has to be done for claiming the benefits under NPS •
PRAN to be opened through company.

- As per the declaration under Flexi Benefits Program, amount will be contributed to the NPS accounts and tax benefits will be extended accordingly.
- Employee cannot get the benefit without PRAN no. To get the PRAN No employee has to raise HR Help desk --> Employee Benefit --> Flexi Benefits
- Employee doesn't have to fill any claim on Galaxy (ZingHR).

9. Voluntary Provident Fund

9.1. Scope

- (a) Employees from DM & above are eligible.
- (b) Voluntary Provident Contribution cannot exceed 88% of the basic salary.
- (c) Employee has to declare desired contribution percentage at the beginning of the year.
- (d) Once opted, the VPF contribution needs to be continued till the end of the financial year.
- (e) VPF contribution will attract same percentage of ROI as in statutory PF.
- (f) Withdrawal features in VPF contribution will be at par with the statutory PF, i.e. tax free withdrawal is permissible after 5 years of continuous contribution.
- (g) VPF is not part of the Flexi Benefit Program. The benefit is as per section 80C of Income Tax Act.
- (h) Employees who had opted for the PF deduction on ceiling basic (Rs. 15000/-) will not be eligible for VPF.

9.2. Procedure to claim: No need of any separate claim since the declared amount will be deducted from monthly salary and contributed in the provident Fund account by the company. Tax benefit will also be extended automatically for the VPF contributed amount.

Amendments to Plan

The Company reserves the right to amend, abrogate, modify, and revise any or all clauses of this plan depending upon statutory and other requirements, market practices or exigencies of business.

Approved By
Chief Human Resources Officer and Head Artificial Intelligence

ANNEXURE 1 – Declaration of Self Owned CAR

Employee Name : _____

Emp Code : _____

Department : _____

Location : _____

Declared hereby that the following vehicle is registered under my name, and I wish to avail of the benefit provided towards fuel reimbursement & maintenance.

Vehicle Registration Number _____

Vehicle Model _____

I also declare that I will avail benefit provided towards driver's allowances. Following are the details

Name of the Driver _____

Driving License (DL) Number (of the driver) _____

LIST OF ENCLOSURES

1. Copy of RC book, which is in the name of employee
2. Copy of Driving License of the driver hired

ANNEXURE 2 – Driver's Receipt Voucher

Employee Name : _____

Emp Code : _____

Department: : _____

Location : _____

Received a sum of Rs. _____ /- (Rupees _____ <in

word> from <Name of employee> _____ on account of dues

for the month of _____ <MMM/YYYY> by:

☐ Cash

☐ Cheque no.....dated.....drawn on bank _____

Rupee 1

Revenue Stamp

<Name and Signature of the Driver with date over the revenue stamp>

Frequently Asked Questions

Q1. How will employee get the tax benefit?

Ans. Employee has to opt for the Flexi Benefits components (as per the grade wise limit) and submit the bills as per eligibility.

Q2. How can employee submit the claim?

Ans. Through Galaxy (ZingHR) in Compensation claim module & by submitting the hard copies required documents to Payroll team.

Path: Galaxy (ZingHR) > Claims > CTC Claims

Q3. What will happen to unclaimed amount by the end of financial year?

Ans. The unclaimed amount will be paid under taxable income at the end of financial year.

Q4. What is the difference between Car allotment and self-own car?

Ans.

Company Owned Car Allotment	Self-owned Car
Applicable for AVP and above Car will be allotted by the company for official purpose after getting in to a financing agreement with Bank or Financial Institution. The EMI will be deducted from salary, maintenance cost and the driver salary will be reimbursed by the employee as non-taxable component.	Applicable for GM and above. Eligible for fuel reimbursement, maintenance and the driver salary for using the car for official purposes.

Q5. Can employee claim LTA for overseas travel?

Ans. No.

Q6. Can employee claim LTA for dependant parents?

Ans. Yes.

Q7. Can employee claim LTA for consecutive two years?

Ans. Yes, in a block of 4 years.

Q8. Can employee claim for communication related expenses for two connections?

Ans. Yes, employees can claim for one mobile, landline and broadband connection, combined or separately.

Q9. Can employee claim communication bill where address is different from address recorded in office?

Ans. No.

Q10. Can employee claim the professional development expense for spouse or children?

Ans. No.

Q11. Can the balance of meal card can be redeemed against cash?

Ans. No.

Q12. What should I do to get my PRAN?

Ans. Employee has to raise a request in ZingHR Portal. HR Ops team will facilitate the process.
HR Help desk --> Employee Benefit --> PRAN Creation/Updation

Q13. Can I use my previous PRAN (Permanent Retirement Allotment Number) for Corp account?

Ans. Yes, but employee has to get this convert from individual to corporate account.

Q14. Can I change my Flexi Benefits during the year? Ans.

No.

Q15. When can a new joiner submit the declaration?

Ans. Employee can submit the declaration in the following month of joining.

Q16. What will happen to my unclaimed amount after separation?

Ans. The unclaimed amount will be paid along with full & final as taxable income.

Q17. Can employee submit unclaimed bills for previous year?

Ans. No, bills should be of same financial year.

Q18. Can I increase my VPF amount to over 88% of my current basic?

Ans. No.

Q19. Can I opt out from or increase my VPF contribution in middle of the financial year?

Ans. No, VPF contribution once opted can't be discontinued or decreased during the financial year.

Q20. Can I modify my Voluntary Provident Fund (VPF) and National Pension Scheme (NPS) post declaration during the same financial year?

Ans. No, employee cannot change more than one in year.

Q21. Why is medical reimbursement and conveyance allowance removed? What happens to the tax exemption available earlier towards these heads?

Ans. Medical reimbursement and Conveyance Allowance as have been merged into "Standard deduction" amounting to Rs. 40,000/-. This tax deduction is available to all employees, and one does not need to submit bills for the medical reimbursements. Therefore, both these components have been removed from pay structure.

Q22. Can I submit bills from online purchases made towards claiming exemption under Books and Periodicals and Professional Development?

Ans. Yes, so long as the bills are under your name.